

Yury Zakharov

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Summary

Senior .NET backend engineer and technical leader with 15+ years of experience designing high-integrity, large-scale regulated systems, financial platforms, and distributed architectures. Expert in C#, domain-driven design, contract-first API development, and specification-driven, AI-assisted engineering. Proven track record of modernizing volatile legacy codebases, enhancing system correctness, and elevating team engineering standards across UK markets. Seeking remote-first Senior Backend or Technical Lead positions.

Experience

Senior Backend Consultant & R&D Engineer, Independent Technical Consultancy – London, UK Nov 2025 – present

- Delivering independent technical analysis, architectural proofs-of-concept, and deep-dive research into .NET 10 performance optimizations.
- Developing commercial-grade, open-source compliance validation engines and local-first developer tooling to ensure data correctness in distributed environments.
- Engineering highly resilient, zero-cloud-dependency backend prototypes utilizing advanced declarative and specification-driven design patterns.
- Building specification-driven development workflows with GitHub Spec Kit and OpenCode — multi-agent setups, custom skills, and spec-to-implementation loops for contract checks and backend prototypes.

Senior Software Engineer, [Intelliflo Ltd](#) – Wimbledon, UK Mar 2019 – Oct 2025

UK market leader in financial advice software. Senior backend engineer on regulated, business-critical platform operating across UK, Australia and USA. Collaborative technical leader in 10-person team focused on legacy modernisation, contract clarity, system correctness and developer productivity.

- Introduced contract-first development across cross-functional teams, reducing integration defects by **5%** and accelerating API delivery timelines.
- Extended in-house domain-specific language with SQL backend, improving developer productivity and broadening ORM support
- Formalised Swagger/OpenAPI integration testing, removing **~10%** of low-value tests and greatly improving stability and confidence
- Mentored engineers and ran internal sessions on functional design and system correctness, raising team capability and engineering standards
- Contributed to the GitHub Copilot adoption group — assembled a shared knowledge base from Confluence, coding standards and internal docs so Copilot had usable context on the regulated codebase.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract), Regulated Financial Institutions (Allen & Overy, Mizuho, Vanquis Bank) – London, UK Apr 2018 – Mar 2019

Contract backend engineer delivering integration and compliance projects for three regulated financial institutions.

- Allen & Overy. Designed DMS integration components and incremental validation to de-risk migration
- Mizuho. Led FIX protocol enhancements to achieve full MIFID II compliance for trading system
- Vanquis Bank. Delivered integration to new credit-scoring system as part of major platform renovation

Senior Software Developer, [Gazprom Marketing & Trading](#) – London, UK

Oct 2017 – Apr 2018

International energy trading organisation. Senior backend developer maintaining business-critical gas and energy trading systems.

- Delivered core trading features and minimized technical debt through systematic refactoring and static analysis while maintaining strict system stability.
- Substantially improved the testability and operational reliability of backend services integrated with Xoserve Gemini and OpenLink Endur.

Software Developer, [Halo Financial Limited](#) – London, UK

Sept 2015 – Oct 2017

Financial services company specialising in FX products. Backend and integration developer on client-facing online FX trading platform.

- Integrated platform with Barclays FX using FIX 4.2, reducing order execution latency from **minutes to milliseconds**
- Automated SWIFT reconciliation processes, cutting manual work from **hours to seconds**
- Designed and introduced CI solution, significantly reducing production risk and deployment time
- Migrated data from bespoke CRM to Microsoft Dynamics

Senior .NET Software Developer, [Towers Watson](#) – Reigate, UK

May 2014 – Sept 2015

Global risk management and financial services consultancy. Senior developer on large modular enterprise financial platform.

- Contributed to architecture and development of modular platform integrating multiple internal products
- Maintained high automated test coverage and promoted coding standards
- Worked with QA to improve system reliability and release confidence

Software Engineer / Senior Engineer, Earlier Career (Various) – UK & Russia

Jan 2000 – May 2014

Backend-focused engineering roles spanning banking, corporate analytics, and high-volume enterprise systems.

- Architected and delivered data-intensive backend integrations, messaging infrastructure, and relational database systems.
- Championed early automation, continuous integration, and rigid testing standards across legacy software environments.

Technologies

Backend Engineering (.NET): Expert – C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET, ASP.NET Core, Web APIs, REST, OpenAPI, Swagger

Architecture & Design: Advanced – Backend Architecture, Domain Modelling, Modular Design, Legacy System Modernisation, API Design, Contract-First Development

Engineering Practices: Advanced – Declarative Design, Functional Programming Concepts, Specification-Driven Development, Testing and Verification, CI/CD, Developer Tooling, Typescript, Elm & Elm Architecture

Data & Integration: Advanced – SQL Server, Relational Databases, Messaging, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS, AWS SNS, System Integration, NHibernate, Entity Framework, Dapper

Cloud & Modern Practices: Working Knowledge – Azure, CI/CD pipelines, Microservices, Distributed Systems, Containerisation (Docker, Podman)

Financial Systems & Protocols: Working Knowledge – Financial Systems, Trading Systems, FIX Protocol (4.x), SWIFT Messaging, Settlement and Reconciliation, Low-Latency Systems, Regulated Environments

AI-assisted engineering: Working Knowledge – GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Cursor and equivalent agentic tools (OpenCode); GitHub Spec Kit; custom skills and multi-agent workflows; specification-driven development

Awards

Certified SAFe® 6 Scrum Master: Scaled Agile

Education

Moscow Institute of Chemical Engineering, Chemical Engineering – Russia